

Absolutely — **treadmill** is a very good Tier 1 target because your passage uses it metaphorically:

> “In reality, it felt more like stepping onto a moving **treadmill**.”

Here **treadmill** does **not** primarily mean exercise equipment. The writer compares viral success to **an endless process where you must keep moving just to maintain your position, without ever reaching a satisfying final destination**.

Word family: **treadmill**

Base word: treadmill

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Main domains: exercise, medicine, psychology, work/life metaphor, economics/social commentary, historical machinery

Meaning in your passage: **treadmill = endless cycle requiring constant effort — 永無止境的循環；不斷追趕卻沒有終點的狀態**

Your sentence:

> “In reality, it felt more like stepping onto a moving **treadmill**.”

Here **treadmill** means:

> **a situation in which you must keep making effort just to continue at the same level, while the target keeps moving and there is no satisfying finishing point.**

繁體中文：

一種必須不停付出、追趕和維持，但始終沒有真正終點或滿足感的循環狀態

Natural translation:

> “it felt more like stepping onto a moving treadmill”

「實際上，那感覺反而更像是踏上一部不停運轉的**跑步機**——你必須一直跑，卻始終沒有真正的終點。」

More naturally, preserving the metaphor:

> **「實際上，那更像是走上一條永不停下來的跑步機：你只能不斷追趕，卻永遠到不了終點。」**

So here:

> ****treadmill** = 不斷追逐下一個數字 / 成功，必須一直努力維持，卻沒有真正滿足終點的循環******

A. EXERCISE MACHINE

1. ****treadmill** = indoor exercise machine for walking/running — 跑步機******

The core modern literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “She runs on the ****treadmill**** every morning.”

「她每天早上都在****跑步機****上跑步。」

Practice 2

> “I walked on the treadmill for thirty minutes.”

「我在****跑步機****上步行了三十分鐘。」

****treadmill** = 有一條持續移動的帶面，讓人在原地步行或跑步的健身器材******

2. ****run on a treadmill** = 在跑步機上跑步******

Practice 3

> “He prefers to ****run on a treadmill**** when it rains.”

「下雨時，他比較喜歡****在跑步機上跑步****。」

Practice 4

> “Running on a treadmill feels different from running outdoors.”

「****在跑步機上跑****跟戶外跑步的感覺不同。」

3. ****walk on a treadmill** = 在跑步機上步行******

Practice 5

> “She started by **walking on the treadmill**.”

「她先從**在跑步機上步行**開始。」

Practice 6

> “You can adjust the speed while walking on the treadmill.”

「你在**跑步機上步行**時可以調整速度。」

B. TREADMILL SETTINGS / EXERCISE LANGUAGE

4. **treadmill speed = 跑步機速度**

Practice 7

> “Increase the **treadmill speed** gradually.”

「逐步提高**跑步機速度**。」

Practice 8

> “The treadmill speed was too fast for me.”

「那部**跑步機的速度**對我來說太快。」

5. **treadmill incline = 跑步機坡度**

Practice 9

> “She increased the **treadmill incline**.”

「她調高了**跑步機坡度**。」

Practice 10

> “Walking at an incline can make treadmill exercise harder.”

「調高坡度步行會令**跑步機運動**更吃力。」

incline = 跑步機帶面模擬上坡的傾斜角度

6. **treadmill belt = 跑步機履帶 / 跑帶**

Practice 11

> “Keep away from the moving **treadmill belt**.”

「不要靠近正在移動的**跑步機跑帶**。」

Practice 12

> “The treadmill belt needs replacing.”

「這部跑步機的**跑帶**需要更換。」

7. **treadmill workout = 跑步機訓練**

Practice 13

> “I did a twenty-minute **treadmill workout**.”

「我做了二十分鐘的**跑步機訓練**。」

Practice 14

> “The programme includes treadmill workouts and strength training.”

「這個訓練計劃包括**跑步機訓練**和力量訓練。」

C. MEDICAL / FITNESS TESTING

8. **treadmill test = 跑步機測試 ; 運動負荷測試**

A major medical use.

Practice 15

> “The doctor recommended a **treadmill test**.”

「醫生建議做一次**跑步機運動測試 / 運動負荷測試**。」

Practice 16

> “His heart rate was monitored during the treadmill test.”

「進行**跑步機測試**期間，他的心率受到監察。」

treadmill test = 讓病人在跑步機上逐步增加運動強度，同時監察心臟等身體反應的測試

9. **treadmill stress test = 跑步機心臟負荷測試**

Practice 17

> “She underwent a **treadmill stress test**.”

「她接受了**跑步機心臟負荷測試**。」

Practice 18

> “The treadmill stress test checks how the heart responds to exercise.”

「**跑步機負荷測試**檢查心臟對運動的反應。」

Common related term:

> **exercise stress test**

10. **treadmill exercise testing = 跑步機運動測試**

More technical/formal.

Practice 19

> “The study used **treadmill exercise testing**.”

「這項研究使用了**跑步機運動測試**。」

Practice 20

> “Treadmill exercise testing can measure exercise capacity.”

「**跑步機運動測試**可以測量運動能力。」

D. REHABILITATION / MEDICAL EQUIPMENT

11. **rehabilitation treadmill = 復康跑步機**

Practice 21

> “The patient practised walking on a rehabilitation treadmill.”

「病人在**復康跑步機**上練習步行。」

Practice 22

> “The treadmill was used during physical rehabilitation.”

「這部跑步機用於**物理復康訓練**。」

12. **body-weight-supported treadmill training = 減重支撐跑步機訓練**

A specialist rehabilitation use.

Practice 23

> “The patient began **body-weight-supported treadmill training**.”

「病人開始接受**減重支撐跑步機訓練**。」

Practice 24

> “The system supports part of the patient’s weight while walking.”

「系統會在患者步行時承托部分體重。」

This is specialist but established in rehabilitation contexts.

E. WORK / DAILY LIFE METAPHOR

13. **treadmill = endless repetitive routine — 單調而永無止境的生活 / 工作循環**

A major figurative meaning.

Practice 25

> “He wanted to escape the daily **treadmill**.”

「他想逃離日復一日、沒完沒了的**生活循環**。」

Practice 26

> “She felt trapped on the treadmill of work and bills.”

「她覺得自己被困在工作和帳單形成的**無休止循環**裡。」

treadmill — figurative = 必須不停重複相同活動、持續付出，卻很難真正向前或獲得自由的生活狀態

14. **be on a treadmill** = 陷入不停奔波的循環

Practice 27

> “Sometimes I feel as if I’m **on a treadmill**.”

「有時我覺得自己好像**一直在原地不停奔波**。」

Practice 28

> “They were on a treadmill of earning and spending.”

「他們陷入了**賺錢、花錢、再賺錢的無限循環**。」

be on a treadmill = 處於需要不停努力、重複，卻沒有真正終點的狀態

15. **get off the treadmill** = 擺脫無休止循環

A common metaphorical construction.

Practice 29

> “She left the job because she wanted to **get off the treadmill**.”

「她辭去工作，因為她想**擺脫沒完沒了的奔波生活**。」

Practice 30

> “He wanted to get off the treadmill of constant competition.”

「他想擺脫**永不停息的競爭循環**。」

get off the treadmill = 停止參與令人疲憊、沒有終點的重複追逐

F. SUCCESS / ACHIEVEMENT METAPHOR

16. **treadmill of success = 不斷追逐成功的循環**

This is directly relevant to your passage.

Practice 31

> “Once she became popular, she entered a **treadmill of success**.”

「她成名後，陷入了**不斷追逐成功的循環**。」

Practice 32

> “The treadmill of online success can become exhausting.”

「網絡成功帶來的**無休止追逐循環**可能令人精疲力竭。」

treadmill of success = 每次成功只帶來下一次更高要求，因此必須不斷追逐下一個成就

17. **performance treadmill = 不斷提高表現要求的循環**

A productive figurative expression.

Practice 33

> “Employees can become trapped on a **performance treadmill**.”

「員工可能陷入**不斷提高表現要求的循環**。」

Practice 34

> “Each achievement simply raised expectations on the performance treadmill.”

「在這種**表現追逐循環**中，每項成就只會令期望進一步提高。」

This is productive metaphorical English rather than one rigid dictionary compound.

G. HEDONIC / PSYCHOLOGICAL TREADMILL

18. **hedonic treadmill = 享樂適應循環；快樂跑步機效應**

A very important psychology compound.

Practice 35

> “Winning more money may not bring lasting happiness because of the **hedonic treadmill**.”

「由於**享樂適應效應**，賺更多錢未必能帶來持久快樂。」

Practice 36

> “The hedonic treadmill helps explain why people quickly adapt to success.”

「**享樂適應循環**可以解釋人們為甚麼很快就習慣成功。」

hedonic treadmill = 人在生活變好或變差後，往往逐漸適應並回到相近的幸福水平，因此需要新的刺激才能再次產生同樣滿足感

This is extremely relevant to the passage:

> 100,000 likes → temporary excitement → desire for even more attention.

19. **hedonic adaptation = 享樂適應**

Closely related concept.

Practice 37

> “Hedonic adaptation can reduce the excitement of success over time.”

「**享樂適應**會令成功帶來的興奮感隨時間減弱。」

Practice 38

> “People often adapt quickly to positive changes.”

「人們往往很快就會適應正面的改變。」

****hedonic treadmill**** is the metaphorical model;
****hedonic adaptation**** is the underlying adaptation process.

H. CONSUMERISM / MONEY

20. ****consumer treadmill = 消費循環；無止境消費追逐****

A social/economic metaphor.

Practice 39

> “Advertising can keep people on a ****consumer treadmill****.”

「廣告可能令人在****無止境的消費循環****中不斷追逐。」

Practice 40

> “They kept buying more without becoming more satisfied.”

「他們不停買更多東西，卻沒有變得更滿足。」

****consumer treadmill = 不斷購買、追逐更新 / 更好的產品，但滿足感很快消失的循環****

21. ****work-and-spend treadmill = 工作—消費循環****

Practice 41

> “He wanted to escape the ****work-and-spend treadmill****.”

「他想擺脫****不停工作、不停消費的循環****。」

Practice 42

> “More spending required more work, keeping them on the same treadmill.”

「花得越多就要工作得越多，使他們一直困在相同的****循環****裡。」

I. CAREER / EMPLOYMENT

22. **career treadmill = 職涯無止境競逐；職場跑步機**

A productive metaphor.

Practice 43

> “She felt trapped on the **career treadmill**.”

「她覺得自己被困在**無止境的職涯競逐**中。」

Practice 44

> “Promotions did not help him escape the career treadmill.”

「升職並沒有令他擺脫**職場不斷追逐的循環**。」

career treadmill = 不斷工作、競爭、升職、追求下一個職涯目標卻始終感到沒有終點的狀態

23. **work treadmill = 無休止的工作循環**

Practice 45

> “She was exhausted by the **work treadmill**.”

「她被**沒完沒了的工作循環**弄得筋疲力盡。」

Practice 46

> “Taking a break helped him step off the work treadmill.”

「休息讓他暫時擺脫了**不停工作的循環**。」

J. SOCIAL MEDIA / ATTENTION ECONOMY

24. **attention treadmill = 不斷追逐注意力的循環**

A highly relevant productive modern metaphor.

Practice 47

> “Creators can become trapped on an **attention treadmill**.”

「創作者可能陷入**不斷追逐注意力的循環**。」

Practice 48

> “The attention treadmill encourages people to keep posting.”

「這種**注意力追逐循環**會令人大量持續發文。」

attention treadmill = 必須不斷製作新內容才能維持觀眾關注的無休止競逐

This is very close to your passage’s meaning.

25. **content treadmill** = 內容生產跑步機；不斷產出內容的循環

Common in creator/business discussions.

Practice 49

> “Many creators feel trapped on the **content treadmill**.”

「很多創作者覺得自己被困在**不停產出內容的循環**。」

Practice 50

> “The content treadmill can lead to burnout.”

「**不停製作內容的循環**可能導致倦怠。」

content treadmill = 為維持演算法、觀眾或流量而被迫不停產生新內容

K. COMPETITION / ESCALATION

26. **competitive treadmill** = 不斷升級的競爭循環

Practice 51

> “Businesses can get caught on a **competitive treadmill**.”

「企業可能陷入**不斷升級的競爭循環**。」

Practice 52

> “Each company spends more simply to keep up with its rivals.”

「每間公司都要花更多資源，只為追上競爭對手。」

****competitive treadmill = 每個參與者都必須不斷增加努力，只為避免落後，而未必真正取得更大優勢****

27. ****keep running just to stay in the same place — 拼命努力卻只能維持原位****

This is the conceptual core of many treadmill metaphors.

Practice 53

> “The business kept spending more just to stay in the same place.”

「企業不停增加支出，卻只是為了****維持原位****。」

Practice 54

> “Online creators may have to work harder simply to maintain the same attention.”

「網絡創作者可能必須更加努力，才能維持相同的關注度。」

This is not a separate dictionary meaning, but it explains the metaphor very precisely.

L. HISTORICAL MACHINE

28. ****treadmill = machine powered by people/animals walking on steps — 人力 / 畜力踏輪機****

Historically, ****treadmill**** did not originally mean modern gym equipment.

Practice 55

> “Workers powered the old ****treadmill**** by walking on its steps.”

「工人踩著階梯，以人力帶動那部舊式****踏輪機****。」

Practice 56

> “Some early treadmills were used to power machinery.”

「一些早期的**踏輪機**用來帶動機械。」

****historical treadmill = 人或動物不斷踩踏輪 / 階梯，以提供機械動力的裝置****

M. HISTORICAL PRISON PUNISHMENT

29. **prison treadmill = 監獄踏輪；懲罰性踏輪勞動**

A historically important sense.

Practice 57

> “Prisoners were forced to work on the ****treadmill****.”

「囚犯被迫在****監獄踏輪****上勞動。」

Practice 58

> “The prison treadmill was used as a form of hard labour.”

「****監獄踏輪****曾被用作苦役的一種形式。」

****prison treadmill = 囚犯長時間踩踏大型踏輪的舊式懲罰 / 勞動制度****

This historical meaning helps explain the modern figurative sense:

> repetitive + exhausting + little apparent progress.

N. INDUSTRIAL / ANIMAL RESEARCH USES

30. **animal treadmill = 動物跑步機**

Used in veterinary/scientific research.

Practice 59

> “The horse was tested on an ****equine treadmill****.”

「那匹馬在****馬匹跑步機****上接受測試。」

Practice 60

> “Researchers measured the rats while they ran on a treadmill.”

「研究人員在老鼠於**跑步機**上運動時進行測量。」

31. **underwater treadmill = 水中跑步機**

Used in rehabilitation and animal therapy.

Practice 61

> “The dog exercised on an **underwater treadmill**.”

「那隻狗在**水中跑步機**上進行復康運動。」

Practice 62

> “Underwater treadmills reduce weight-bearing during rehabilitation.”

「**水中跑步機**可在復康期間減少身體承重。」

O. DESK / WORKSTATION COMPOUNDS

32. **treadmill desk = 跑步機辦公桌；步行辦公桌**

A modern compound.

Practice 63

> “She uses a **treadmill desk** while answering emails.”

「她回覆電郵時會使用**跑步機辦公桌**。」

Practice 64

> “A treadmill desk allows users to walk slowly while working.”

「**步行辦公桌**讓使用者一邊工作一邊慢慢步行。」

P. SPECIALIST ECONOMIC / AGRICULTURAL METAPHOR

33. **technology treadmill / technological treadmill = 技術競逐循環**

An economics/agriculture concept.

Practice 65

> “Farmers may become caught on a **technological treadmill**.”

「農民可能陷入**不斷採用新技術的競逐循環**。」

Practice 66

> “Early adopters gain temporarily, but competitors eventually catch up.”

「早期採用者最初會取得優勢，但競爭者最終也會追上。」

technological treadmill = 參與者必須不斷採用新技術才能保持競爭力，而優勢往往只是暫時的

Specialist:

- * economics
- * agriculture
- * business strategy

Q. “TREADMILL EFFECT”

34. **treadmill effect = 跑步機效應；越努力越只能維持原位的效應**

A broad metaphor used in several fields.

Practice 67

> “The policy created a **treadmill effect** in which costs kept rising.”

「這項政策造成了一種**跑步機效應**，成本不斷上升。」

Practice 68

> “Workers had to increase output simply to maintain the same income.”

「工人必須提高產量，卻只是為了維持相同收入。」

treadmill effect = 因環境 / 競爭持續變動，個體必須不斷增加努力才能維持原有位置的現象

Important:

The precise technical meaning depends on the field.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs running machine**

treadmill

= standard modern English term.

running machine

= understandable, but much less standard as the normal product name.

So:

> treadmill 

> running machine 

Important distinction: **treadmill vs exercise bike**

treadmill

= walk/run.

exercise bike

= cycle while stationary.

Both:

> stationary exercise equipment

but different movement.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs track**

treadmill

= moving belt; person remains roughly in one physical place.

running track

= fixed surface; runner physically travels around it.

This difference is exactly why treadmill works so well metaphorically.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs conveyor belt**

They look mechanically similar.

treadmill

= moving belt intended for a person/animal to walk or run on.

conveyor belt

= moving belt intended to transport objects/materials.

> treadmill

> = 人在帶上移動

> conveyor belt

> = 物件被帶移動

Important distinction: **treadmill vs routine**

routine

= repeated normal pattern.

treadmill

= repeated pattern specifically experienced as:

- * exhausting,
- * compulsory,
- * endless,
- * producing little sense of progress.

So:

- > morning routine
- > can be pleasant.

- > daily treadmill
- > usually carries a negative sense.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs cycle**

cycle

= repeating sequence.

treadmill

= repeating sequence requiring continuous effort without satisfying progress.

- > cycle of seasons
- > = 季節循環 , neutral

- > treadmill of work
- > = 無止境、令人疲憊的工作循環

Treadmill is much more evaluative.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs rat race**

rat race

= exhausting competition for wealth/status/success against other people.

treadmill

= endless activity/effort, even without direct competition.

- > corporate rat race
- > = 職場競爭

- > work treadmill
- > = 日復一日無休止工作

A rat race can be one type of treadmill.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs vicious cycle**

vicious cycle

= one negative factor causes another, which feeds back and worsens the first.

treadmill

= constant effort needed to maintain position or chase an ever-moving target.

Example:

> anxiety → checking → more anxiety

> = vicious cycle

> more likes → higher expectations → need for more likes

> = treadmill

Your passage contains elements of both, but **treadmill** specifically emphasizes perpetual movement.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs hamster wheel**

These metaphors are very close.

treadmill

= continuous enforced effort with no endpoint.

hamster wheel

= repetitive activity that produces little real progress.

> stuck on a treadmill

> stuck on a hamster wheel

Both can translate naturally as:

> **困在原地不停奔跑的循環**

Hamster wheel is more informal and visually comic.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs slippery slope**

Completely different metaphors.

treadmill

= endless repetition/effort.

slippery slope

= one step may lead progressively to increasingly serious consequences.

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs escalation**

escalation

= increase in intensity/scale.

treadmill

= you must continue increasing effort because expectations/environment keep moving.

So escalation can create a treadmill.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs burnout**

treadmill

= the endless process/environment.

burnout

= possible psychological/physical result of prolonged stress.

> content treadmill

> may lead to

> burnout

Not synonyms.

Important distinction: **treadmill vs hedonic treadmill**

treadmill

general metaphor:

= endless repetitive effort without reaching a final point.

hedonic treadmill

specific psychology concept:

= people adapt to gains/losses and tend toward a relatively stable level of happiness.

The second is a specialized compound, not merely “being busy”.

Important distinction: **hedonic treadmill vs addiction**

hedonic treadmill

= adaptation causes the previous reward to feel normal, so more/new reward may be sought.

addiction

= compulsive behaviour/substance use involving impaired control and other features.

They can interact, but they are not equivalent.

In your passage, the writer uses **treadmill metaphorically**, not as a clinical diagnosis of addiction.

Important distinction: **treadmill and finish line in your passage**

The passage deliberately contrasts:

> **finish line**

with:

> **moving treadmill**

The metaphors imply opposite models of success.

Finish line

> success has a clear endpoint.

“You reach 100,000 likes → you have arrived.”

Treadmill

> success moves the target again.

“You reach 100,000 → now you wonder about 120,000 → 130,000 → next post → next success.”

So the exact conceptual contrast is:

> **achievement with closure**

> vs

> **achievement that creates another demand**

This is central to the paragraph.

Important distinction: **moving treadmill**

Strictly speaking, an ordinary treadmill is already moving when in use.

The writer says:

> “stepping onto a moving treadmill”

to intensify the image:

> **the process is already moving, and once you step onto it you immediately have to keep pace.**

This supports the sense of:

* loss of control

* continuous pressure

* no stationary resting point

Important distinction: **on the treadmill vs on a treadmill**

Literal:

> “She is on a treadmill.”

= 她在跑步機上。

Figurative:

> “He feels trapped on the treadmill.”

= 他覺得自己陷入沒完沒了的循環。

Context determines whether the object is physical or metaphorical.

Important distinction: **treadmill — literal vs figurative**

Literal

> “I ran on the treadmill.”

= 我在跑步機上跑。

Figurative

> “I’m tired of the career treadmill.”

= 我厭倦了無止境的職涯競逐。

Excellent MCQ contrast.

Important distinction: **treadmill — modern vs historical**

Modern

> exercise machine

Historical

> human/animal-powered stepping wheel, sometimes used for prison labour

The underlying mechanical concept remains:

> **continuous stepping drives the mechanism while the person stays in roughly the same place**

This is the semantic basis of the modern metaphor.

Family / compound sweep

Following the fuller reference level, the useful inventory includes:

* **treadmill — exercise machine** = 跑步機
* **run on a treadmill** = 在跑步機上跑
* **walk on a treadmill** = 在跑步機上步行
* **treadmill speed** = 跑步機速度
* **treadmill incline** = 跑步機坡度
* **treadmill belt** = 跑步機跑帶
* **treadmill workout** = 跑步機訓練
* **treadmill test** = 跑步機運動測試
* **treadmill stress test** = 跑步機心臟負荷測試
* **rehabilitation treadmill** = 復康跑步機
* **underwater treadmill** = 水中跑步機
* **treadmill desk** = 步行 / 跑步機辦公桌
* **treadmill — figurative routine** = 無休止的重複循環
* **be on a treadmill** = 陷入不停奔波的循環
* **get off the treadmill** = 擺脫無休止循環
* **treadmill of success** = 不斷追逐成功的循環
* **career treadmill** = 職涯無止境競逐
* **work treadmill** = 無休止工作循環
* **attention treadmill** = 不斷追逐注意力的循環
* **content treadmill** = 不斷產出內容的循環
* **competitive treadmill** = 不斷升級的競爭循環
* **consumer treadmill** = 無止境消費循環
* **hedonic treadmill** = 享樂適應循環
* **technological treadmill** = 技術競逐循環
* **treadmill effect** = 跑步機效應
* **historical treadmill** = 人力 / 畜力踏輪機
* **prison treadmill** = 監獄懲罰性踏輪

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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treadmill — exercise	有持續移動跑帶，讓人在原地步行或跑步的健身器材
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treadmill speed	跑步機跑帶移動的速度	
treadmill incline	跑步機模擬上坡的傾斜程度	
treadmill belt	人實際踩踏 / 跑步的移動帶面	
treadmill test	在跑步機上逐步運動並監察身體反應的測試	
treadmill stress test	透過跑步機運動測量心臟承受負荷時反應的醫療測試	
rehabilitation treadmill	用於恢復步行 / 運動能力的復康跑步機	
underwater treadmill	讓人在水中步行 / 跑步以減低承重的復康設備	
treadmill desk	讓人一邊慢速步行一邊工作的跑步機辦公設備	
treadmill — figurative	必須不停重複付出努力，卻難以真正前進或到達終點的生活 / 工作狀態	
be on a treadmill	陷入需要不停努力和重複、卻沒有真正終點的循環	
get off the treadmill	擺脫令人疲憊、持續追逐的生活 / 工作循環	
treadmill of success	每次成功只產生下一個更高目標，因此必須不斷追逐的循環	
career treadmill	不斷工作、競爭和追逐下一個職涯成就的循環	
attention treadmill	必須不斷製造新刺激 / 內容才能維持他人注意的循環	
content treadmill	為維持流量、演算法或觀眾而不停製作新內容的循環	
consumer treadmill	不斷購買更多 / 更新產品，但滿足感很快消失的循環	
competitive treadmill	各方必須不斷增加投入才能避免落後、卻未必取得長期優勢的狀態	
hedonic treadmill	人適應成功 / 改善後，滿足感逐漸回落，因此繼續追求新刺激的心理現象	
technological treadmill	必須持續採用新技術才能保持競爭位置的循環	
treadmill effect	因環境持續變化而必須增加努力才能維持原有位置的效應	
historical treadmill	人或動物持續踩踏以提供機械動力的舊式踏輪裝置	
prison treadmill	曾用作囚犯苦役 / 懲罰的持續踩踏裝置	

For your original passage

> “Before this happened, I might have assumed that getting 100,000 likes would feel like reaching a finish line. In reality, it felt more like stepping onto a moving ****treadmill****.”

The exact meaning is:

****treadmill** = 作者原以為 100,000 likes 是一個可以「完成」的成功目標，但真正達到之後，並沒有得到終點式的滿足，反而立即開始在意下一個數字、下一篇貼文、下一次成功；因此像站上跑步機一樣，必須不停向前跑，卻始終沒有真正抵達終點。 ******

Natural translation:

> ******「在事情發生之前，我可能會以為得到十萬個讚會像衝過終點線一樣。但實際上，那感覺更像是踏上一部已經開始運轉的跑步機——你只能不停地跑，卻沒有真正的終點。」 ******

The highest-value contrasts are:

> ****exercise treadmill**** → 跑步機

> ****treadmill test**** → 跑步機運動負荷測試

- > ****daily treadmill**** → 日復一日、無休止的生活循環
- > ****be on a treadmill**** → 陷入不停奔波的循環
- > ****get off the treadmill**** → 擺脫這種無止境循環
- > ****career treadmill**** → 無止境的職涯追逐
- > ****attention treadmill**** → 不斷追逐關注的循環
- > ****content treadmill**** → 不斷製作內容以維持流量的循環
- > ****hedonic treadmill**** → 享樂適應循環
- > ****prison treadmill**** → 歷史上的監獄踏輪苦役
- > ****treadmill vs finish line**** → ****成功後目標繼續移動**** vs ****成功有清楚終點****